

So what is it like?

This false colour picture of Venus was made from data collected by probes, including the *Magellan* probe, sent to Venus between 1989 and 1992. The blue areas represent huge plains of solid lava.

The white, green, and brown areas are higher land, such as hills, mountains, volcanoes, and valleys.

The surface temperature is about 482°C (900°F).

Turn and learn

The red planet:

pp. 64-65

The ringed planet:

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Venus spins on its axis slower than any other planet. It takes 243 Earth days to just spin once.

Surface of Venus

Maat Mons is the highest volcano on Venus. This view of the surface of the planet exaggerates the height of Maat Mons to show its slopes in more detail. The volcano is named after Ma'at, the Egyptian goddess of truth and justice.

Venus spins in the opposite direction to the Earth, meaning the Sun rises in the west and sets in the east.